disappointed and disillusioned. ‘I do not think we got a fair deal. I believe very important consequences hang upon the ultimate settlement of our problem of sterling balances with the UK. Unless a satisfactory conclusion is reached on this issue, I am afraid the trade relations, old and intimate as they have been for many years past, between India and the UK are likely to be disturbed.’[35] Wallace wrote back saying that he had heard from several directions that Shroff had acquitted himself splendidly at Bretton Woods and had presented India’s case with the greatest ability and that no one could have done better.

Shroff and Chetty courted some controversy on their return from Bretton Woods, when in a statement at Karachi to *The Times of India*, they said that while Raisman had supported the Indian cause admirably, the maintaining of India’s prestige demanded that the leader of future Indian delegations to international conferences should be an Indian. The fact that the leader at Bretton Woods was not an Indian was embarrassing and humiliating.[36] Given Raisman’s leadership of the delegation this was as Chandavarkar put it ‘misplaced nationalist *amour propre*’[37] for no Indian could have done more or any better. Raisman had made it a point to keep the delegation fully informed about his interactions with the other delegations particularly with Keynes and the UK delegation. Madan recalled that even though as Secretary he was technically not a delegate, Raisman encouraged him to participate fully in meetings. Even though he was the leader of the delegation, Raisman delegated all the principal responsibilities to his Indian colleagues and at no point did he try to influence or pressure the Indian members. Deshmukh emerged as the *de facto* leader on the quota question and Shroff the principal spokesman on the convertibility of the sterling balances. Chetty played a similar role in the debate on the objectives of the Fund.

Deshmukh narrates how in New York, on the way back from the Conference, Raisman sounded him out on a possible exchange of posts between Deshmukh and himself. Deshmukh said that it was doubtful if the Central Board of the RBI would ever agree to the appointment of a Britisher as Governor. But Deshmukh was destined to become Union Finance Minister, though the events of his tenure are beyond the scope of this book.

Referring to the US reluctance to support India, Deshmukh in a talk in October 1944 in Bombay said that it was clear from the beginning that India